



João Blasques

AI-Enabled Data Engineer — data & software background since 2009, full-time data engineering since 2023.

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SUMMARY

I build data platforms the way software should be built. Tested transforms. CI/CD. Infrastructure as code. Data-quality gates that fail the build instead of writing a report nobody reads. My data and software background goes back to 2009, at Universidade Nova de Lisboa (web development, GIS analysis, BI). I've been doing data engineering full-time since 2023.

The chapter in between was several years repairing wind-turbine blades on ropes, offshore. That was deliberate, hands-on, high-stakes work where a mistake shows up immediately. I brought that same discipline into software: document the trade-offs, check claims against evidence, don't ship what I can't defend.

"AI-enabled" means I run an agent-operated development workflow (Claude Code, CLI-first infrastructure) and I build AI systems too: feature stores, embedding search, LLM-powered pipelines. That work is part of the data platform I build, not a separate thing I do on the side.

EXPERIENCE

Data Engineer — DataStuff.nl (freelance) — Oct 2023 – Present Remote, part-time/freelance. I build governed lakehouses on Databricks and GCP: medallion architecture, dbt transformations and tests, Great Expectations data-quality gates wired into CI, Spark Structured Streaming, Terraform with keyless (WIF) CI. Public showcase of this work: [Vitals](#) (a healthcare lakehouse) and [MBTA](#) (a streaming transit lakehouse).

Blade Repair Technician — various contracts (Muehlhan Wind, GEV Wind Power, Blade defence, Global Wind Service) — Apr 2021 – Dec 2024 Offshore and onshore wind farms in Sweden, Norway, Greece, and Germany, on Vestas and Siemens Gamesa/GE turbines. Leading-edge protection and overlamination repair, uptower upgrades, de-icing and lightning-protection system commissioning, rope-access inspection. The final contract (Global Wind Service, Feb – Dec 2024) overlapped with the DataStuff.nl freelance work above — that overlap was the transition period before data engineering became full-time.

EDUCATION

- **Master's degree, GeoSpatial Technologies** — NOVA IMS Information Management School (2010 – 2012)
- **Bachelor's degree, Environmental Engineering Technology** — Universidade Nova de Lisboa (1995 – 2001)

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Databricks Fundamentals** — Databricks (issued Jun 2025)

SKILLS

Three tiers, each backed by something I've actually shipped and can point to. Full detail with per-skill evidence links: joaoblasques.com/skills. I'm not claiming anything below at a depth the public work doesn't support.

Core — use daily, will defend in depth: Python, SQL · Databricks (Unity Catalog, Delta, Asset Bundles, serverless Jobs, Lakeflow/DLT) · Lakehouse design (medallion, policy-in-gold) · dbt · Data-quality gates (Great Expectations + dbt tests in CI) · CI/CD & IaC (GitHub Actions, Terraform, keyless WIF/OIDC) · Cost discipline (DBU attribution, budget alerts)

Working — shipped with it, still deepening: Spark Structured Streaming (Auto Loader, Kafka) · GCP data stack (GCS, Pub/Sub, Cloud Run, Cloud Scheduler) · Airflow · Feast feature store · pgvector / embeddings · MLflow · Agentic/LLM pipeline patterns · Docker

Familiar — used, not claiming depth: DuckDB & Postgres · BigQuery · Azure/AWS fundamentals · Kubernetes basics · Scala/Java (read comfortably) · Tableau/PowerBI basics

BEYOND WORK

I volunteer time and skills where they're useful — disaster-relief work (2004 Indian Ocean tsunami, Tamil Nadu) and long-term social projects in India and the Philippines.